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Creativity and Laboratory of Ideas

Introduction

Do you know how can you be more creative? How can you generate new ideas? Do you wish to see how effectively and creatively can you solve problems that organizations face? This course is going to address, precisely these questions. Being creative in business is not a choice, it's an obligation. Managers' ability to come up with new and useful ideas is becoming more important as the competitive field has moved from efficiency to innovation. Great businesses are created around the commercialization of creative products and services all the way from fashion, art, perfumes, theater, or entertainment. This course, taking inputs from psychology, art, anthropology and management research, addresses following questions.

1. What makes us more creative? What kind of situation, problems, motivation bring out our creative best?
2. What doesn't allow us to explore our creativity? Understanding individual blocks to creativity and strategies for unblocking creativity
3. Profiles of creative individuals and their life experiences

Objectives

The objectives of the course are to learn about the various faces of creativity through concepts and theories of creativity, to share with creative people in various industries and crafts about how they experience the creative process and how it can be translated to the business world, and to experience creative techniques through exercises. The course focuses on both individual as well as organizational creativity and its determinants. Through various exercises students will discover their personal stimulators and blocks to creativity, while working in a group or alone. The course aims at making students aware of their individual creative profile personal motivators as well as individual blocks to creativity. Another important objective of the course is to identify strategies for designing organizations where creativity can be fostered among individuals for a greater innovation performance. Finally, as mentioned before, we will invite organizations to share their problems and participants, in a laboratory-type setting, will try to find creative solutions to their problems. Following are the principal learning objectives of the course.

1. Ability to understand one's own cognitive journey in generation of ideas
2. Ability to understand one's own blocks to creativity
3. Identification of one's own 'creative comfort zone' i.e. what inspires one the most to come up with creative ideas
4. Identification of different techniques of idea generation for different situations

5. Ability to analyze problems and challenges to ascertain the appropriate creativity technique to resolve it

Content

The 10 sessions will be roughly divided into three parts:

- I. Lectures and discussions to learn about different models and concepts of creativity
- II. Speakers from the world of business and arts, that will share with us how they structure creativity in their work
- III. Creative exercises to experience how to stimulate creativity and how to identify and de-fuse blocks to creativity

Evaluation

Evaluation will be based on class participation and an individual project based on the exploration of a particular aspect of individual creativity using concepts and techniques developed during the course as well as the punctual submission of diary of creative encounters.

The evaluation will be done as following,

- Class participation – 45%
- Individual Project – 25%
- Diary of creative encounters – 30%

SE1 (Writing works and Presentations) – Diary of Creative Encounters: 30%

SE2 (Class participation) :45%

SE2 Individual Project : 25%

Course Outline & Bibliography

Session	Title and Material
1	Introduction to the Concept
	• Creativity as investment.' Sternberg, R.J., O'Hara, L.A. and LuBart, T.I., 1997. California Management Review 40, pp. 8–32. • Inspiration and Time's flow from Free Play by Stephen Nachmanovitch. J.P. Tarcher, Inc. (1990) - Paperback - 208 pages - ISBN 0874776317 • "Improvisational Brain.' By Amanda Rose Martinez. Seed Magazine. December 2010
2	Understanding Creativity
3	A Creative Act • Creativity in Advertising. When it works and when it doesn't. By Werner Reinartz and Peter Saffert. Harvard Business Review. June 2013
4	Creative Problem Solving
5	Creative Problem Solving • Sparking creativity in teams: An executive's guide. By: Capozzi, Maria M., Dye, Renée, Howe, Amy, McKinsey Quarterly, 00475394, 2011, Issue 2
6	Creative Personality and Creative Intelligence
7	Creative Personality and Creative Intelligence

	• Sherlock Holmes, Importance of Imagination • Reclaim your creative confidence. <i>Harvard BusinessReview</i>
8	Techniques for Creativity
9	Techniques for Creativity
	• Design Thinking, <i>Harvard Business Review</i> • What's the secret of better brainstorming • Multi-Sensory Creative Thinking
10	Laboratory of ideas – solving real world problems
	• Amabile, T. "Motivating Creativity in Organizations : On Loving what You Love To Do." California Management Review. Fall 1997. Vol. 40 Issue 1, p39-58, 20p
•	• Amabile, T. M. and Khair, M. (2008). `Creativity and the role of the leader`. Harvard Business Review, 86(10), 100-109

Bibliography

Professor's Biography



Kandarp Mehta
Senior Lecturer

PhD in Management. IESE, University of Navarra

Visiting Scholar, DRRC – Kellogg School of Management

Master of Business Administration, K.S.School of Business Management, Gujarat University

Kandarp Mehta is a PhD from IESE Business School, Barcelona. He has been with the Entrepreneurship Department at IESE since October 2009. His research has focused on creativity in organizations and negotiations. He frequently works as consultant with startups on issues related to Innovation and Creativity. His doctoral thesis was about the process of creativity in the context of motion picture industry. He has conducted several Negotiation and Creativity Workshops for corporate executives and management students in Europe, USA and India. Before coming to Spain, he was at ICFAI Business School in India where he taught Corporate Finance. He is also actively involved with Creative Industries. He has been actively involved with theatre, as a director, script writer as well as a performer. Several movies and short films where he participated during his PhD dissertation have been exhibited at prestigious film festivals.

Additional Information for Reporting and Accreditation purposes

Learning Goals & Learning Objectives

Learning Goals & Learning Objectives are statements that describe the knowledge, skills and attitudes students should acquire by the end of a particular course, and help students understand why that knowledge and those skills will be useful to them.

*Please choose **1 Learning Goal (LG)** from the 2 proposed, and a **minimum of 2 Learning Objectives (LO)** from the individual list of the LG chosen.*

LG1: The general management outlook

LO 2. Students will be able to assess the impact of their decisions on the different stakeholders of the company.

LO 3. Students will be able to evaluate the impact of their decisions on the different departments of the company.

LG2: Leadership with Impact

LO 1. Students will learn how to empower others, to develop talent, to lead with integrity, to inspire those around them.

LO 2. Students will build alignment around common goals, commitment to shared values.

LO 4. Students will apply the mechanisms that generate a collaborative environment, communication and trust between the members of a team or organization.

Learning Outcomes

Choose the ones that are addressed directly or indirectly in your course among the ones below (please ignore the references, as they are for internal purposes).

1. Critically evaluate relevant information for better decision-making.

22. Analyze the impact of business decisions from the perspective of general management operating in a globally competitive context.

23. Apply entrepreneurial behavior with a creative and open mindset, driving necessary changes with energy and personal responsibility.

OP9. Build and manage interactive data systems, model, and analyze information for decision-making.

OP10. Evaluate new businesses in their early stages for initial rounds of financing.

OP12. Conceptualize, design, analyze, and apply new business models.

Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)

Choose the ones that are addressed directly or indirectly in your course among the ones below.

For official reporting purposes, we are required to state below the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) discussed in this course. This list is not intended to serve as an illustration of how to approach sustainability issues. We acknowledge that there might be other relevant topics on sustainability not included in the SDGs that might also be addressed in class.

SDG 4 – Quality Education

SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities

SDG 17 – Partnerships for the Goals